Founder Dependency Audit™

Structural Assessment of Organisational Dependency
Dependency Index
59.4%
Moderate Dependency
Founder Dependency Profile™
The Central Founder
Prepared for
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Organisation
Mitchell Advisory Group
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Kaylee-Jane · Structural Governance & Operational Architecture
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Structural Notice

This report assesses the structural architecture of your organisation — not your leadership capability, personal effectiveness, or management style.

The findings contained in this report describe conditions that exist within your organisation's design. They are not a reflection of your competence as a founder or leader.

Structural dependency is not a leadership failure.
It is a design condition.

It can be measured. It can be classified. It can be addressed through deliberate structural redesign.

This report tells you where that redesign is required.

Executive Summary

This audit assessed the structural architecture of Mitchell Advisory Group across five dimensions of founder dependency: Decision Authority, Knowledge & Intelligence, Relationship & Authority, Operational Continuity, and Leadership Architecture.

The assessment returns a Dependency Index of **59.4%**, placing Mitchell Advisory Group in the **Moderate Dependency** classification. Dependency is present but contained. Specific dimensions require deliberate structural attention.

The most significant knowledge concentration is recorded in Knowledge & Intelligence, where the assessment identifies a High Dependency classification at 66.7%. Critical organisational knowledge is personally held and has not been structurally captured.

The immediate structural priority is the initiation of a knowledge capture programme beginning with client knowledge and operational processes — the two domains where knowledge loss creates the most acute and most immediate commercial risk.

Dependency Index Dashboard

59.4%
Overall Dependency Index
Moderate Dependency

Dimension	Score	Classification
Decision Authority	62.5%	High Dependency
Knowledge & Intelligence	66.7%	High Dependency
Relationship & Authority	62.5%	High Dependency
Operational Continuity	45.8%	Moderate Dependency
Leadership Architecture	58.3%	Moderate Dependency

Dependency Spectrum
Structural
Independence Low Moderate High Critical

Dimension 01

Decision
Authority
62.5%
High Dependency
Finding
Decision authority exists informally across the leadership layer but has not been structurally assigned. The leadership team makes decisions — but only the ones the founder has not claimed, and only when the founder is unavailable. Authority is exercised by proximity and habit, not by design.
Implication
The leadership team is capable of deciding. The structure does not confirm that they can. The result is a leadership layer that seeks validation rather than exercises authority — not because of who they are, but because of how the architecture is designed.
Structural Cost
The organisation pays a leadership tax on every decision that should be made at a lower level but travels upward instead. That tax is measured in time, leadership capacity, and organisational momentum.
Risk
Decision authority concentration at this level creates a visible leadership bottleneck. As the organisation grows, the bottleneck tightens. Growth does not resolve authority concentration. It exposes it.
Design Priority
Define and document the decision authority held by each leadership role. Include specific thresholds, parameters, and the conditions under which escalation is structurally required rather than culturally habitual.

Dimension 02

Knowledge &
Intelligence
66.7%
High Dependency

Finding
Significant organisational knowledge remains personally held across multiple domains. Documentation exists but it is incomplete, inconsistently maintained, and not structured to the standard required for operational independence. The organisation relies on the founder's memory to fill the gaps. Those gaps are larger than they appear.
Implication
New leaders cannot reach full operational effectiveness without extended founder involvement. Client relationships cannot be transferred cleanly. Processes cannot be executed consistently without reference to institutional memory that only the founder holds.
Structural Cost
Leadership onboarding is slower and more expensive than it should be. Client transitions carry unnecessary risk. Operational consistency is founder-dependent rather than architecturally guaranteed.
Risk
Knowledge visibility is degraded across the organisation. The leadership team cannot see the full picture of what the organisation knows, has agreed to, or has learned. Decisions made without that visibility are structurally compromised.
Design Priority
Conduct a structured knowledge audit. Identify the highest-risk knowledge gaps. Prioritise documentation of client knowledge, key commercial relationships, and the strategic reasoning behind current operational design decisions.

Dimension 03

Relationship &
Authority
62.5%
High Dependency
Finding
The majority of the organisation's significant external relationships are founder-dependent. The leadership team has external presence but lacks the structural authority and organisational backing to hold senior relationships independently. External stakeholders default to the founder for any conversation of consequence — not because the leadership team is incapable, but because the organisation has not structurally transferred authority to them.
Implication
Client retention, partnership renewal, and commercial negotiation all require founder involvement regardless of the leadership team's capability. The organisation's external visibility is filtered through one person.
Structural Cost
The founder's time is consumed by relationship maintenance that should be distributed across the leadership layer. That consumption limits the founder's capacity for strategic leadership and limits the organisation's capacity for commercial growth simultaneously.
Risk
Relationship visibility is concentrated. The organisation cannot see its own external relationships clearly because they are held personally rather than institutionally. That visibility gap creates commercial risk that is difficult to quantify and easy to underestimate.
Design Priority
Develop a structured relationship transition programme. Define which relationships transfer to which leadership roles, establish a timeline, and begin introducing organisational authority alongside founder presence in senior external conversations.

Dimension 04

Operational
Continuity
45.8%
Moderate Dependency
Finding

The organisation has partial continuity capacity. Core operational functions continue without the founder under normal conditions. Financial authorities above defined thresholds, significant client decisions, and non-routine operational challenges continue to require founder involvement even during planned absences. The architecture handles the expected. It has not been designed for the unexpected.

Implication

The organisation can manage planned, short-term founder absences. It is not structurally prepared for extended or unplanned absence. Its continuity capacity is sufficient for predictable conditions and insufficient for the ones that matter most.

Structural Cost

Non-routine operational challenges carry a disproportionate continuity cost. The organisation pays this cost intermittently rather than continuously — which makes it easy to underestimate and difficult to justify addressing until it becomes acute.

Risk

The gap between planned and unplanned absence is where this architecture fails. The organisation has designed for the former and left the latter to chance.

Design Priority

Extend the continuity design to cover the domains that currently require founder involvement during absence. Address financial authority thresholds and non-routine decision escalation protocols specifically.

Dimension 05

Leadership
Architecture
58.3%
Moderate Dependency

Finding

The organisation has a partially designed leadership architecture. Leadership roles have defined authorities and accountabilities in most domains. The leadership team functions with reasonable structural coherence under normal operating conditions. Leadership visibility exists at the individual role level but is incomplete at the collective governance level — it is possible to see what each leader owns, but not how the leadership layer functions as a structural whole.

Implication

The leadership layer holds the organisation effectively under stable conditions. It shows architectural strain when facing non-routine challenges, significant decisions, or the need to operate without founder involvement for extended periods.

Structural Cost

The organisation pays a governance cost at the leadership layer level. Decisions that require collective leadership authority are slower, less consistent, and more founder-dependent than they should be given the seniority of the people involved.

Risk

Partially designed leadership architecture is stable under normal conditions and fragile under pressure. The architectural gaps that are invisible today become structural vulnerabilities when the organisation faces its next significant challenge.

Design Priority

Complete the leadership architecture design. Address the informal dependencies that remain within the leadership layer. Establish the governance structures required for the leadership team to function as a fully independent organisational body.

Founder Dependency Profile™

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The Central Founder

The founder is structurally central to the organisation's function. This is not a reflection of the founder's willingness to delegate — it is a reflection of the organisation's structural design. The architecture routes authority, knowledge, relationships, and decisions through the founder because no alternative architecture has been built. The organisation is performing, but its performance is structurally dependent on a single individual.

Organisational Signature

- The organisation performs. Its performance is architecturally dependent on one person.
- The leadership team exists. It does not hold the organisation independently.
- Authority, knowledge, and relationships are concentrated rather than distributed.
- The structure has not been designed. It has accumulated.

Structural Risk Register

Ref	Dimension	Risk Description	Severity
SR-01	Decision Authority	Decision authority is informally distributed but not structurally designed. The leadership team makes decisions within unwritten boundaries that shift with context. Authority concentration at the founder level remains significant across most operational domains.	HIGH
SR-02	Knowledge & Intelligence	Significant organisational knowledge remains personally held across multiple domains. Documentation is incomplete and inconsistently maintained. The organisation relies on the founder's memory to fill structural knowledge gaps.	HIGH
SR-03	Relationship & Authority	The majority of significant external relationships are founder-dependent. The leadership team lacks the structural authority and organisational backing to hold senior relationships independently. Commercial growth is constrained by the founder's personal relationship capacity.	HIGH
SR-04	Operational Continuity	Partial continuity capacity exists for planned, short-term founder absence. The organisation is not structurally prepared for extended or unplanned absence. Financial authority thresholds and non-routine decision escalation remain founder-dependent.	MODERATE
SR-05	Leadership Architecture	The leadership architecture is partially designed and functions under normal conditions. Informal dependencies remain within the leadership layer that become structural vulnerabilities under pressure or during extended founder absence.	MODERATE

Critical
High
Moderate

Structural Action Framework

Immediate Structural Interventions
0 — 90 days

- 1 Knowledge & Intelligence Initiate a knowledge capture programme beginning with client knowledge and operational processes — the two domains with the highest immediate commercial risk.
- 2 Decision Authority Design and implement a decision rights framework that defines which decisions can be made at each structural level without escalation.
- 3 Relationship & Authority Introduce leadership team members into the organisation's most significant client and partner relationships with a structured transition plan.

Structural Design Priorities
3 — 12 months

- 1 Leadership Architecture Establish a leadership governance structure — meeting architecture, decision protocol, and collective accountability framework.

- 2 Operational Continuity Test the operational continuity structure under a planned extended absence before it is required under unplanned conditions.

Architectural Objectives
12+ months

- 1 Maintain the decision rights framework as a living document. Review it at each significant structural change.
- 2 Review and update the leadership architecture at each significant change in organisational scale or strategic direction.
- 3 Ensure all new significant relationships are institutionalised from the outset rather than allowed to become personally dependent.

What Comes Next

This audit has identified the structural conditions within Mitchell Advisory Group that require architectural attention. The findings are a starting point, not a destination. The following Kaylee-Jane products and services provide the structural design frameworks required to address them.

Flagship Product
The Organisational Design System™
The complete structural design framework for founders and leadership teams ready to architect their organisation for independence, scale, and resilience.
Advisory Service
Structural Governance Advisory™
A direct advisory engagement for organisations requiring guided structural redesign across governance, accountability, and decision architecture.
Workshop
Accountability Chart Workshop™
A facilitated session that designs the accountability architecture of your leadership layer — roles, authorities, and structural ownership.
Diagnostic
Organisational Maturity Evaluation™
The next diagnostic instrument — assessing structural design maturity across six governance dimensions with a full maturity profile and gap analysis.
Begin the Structural Conversation

If the findings in this report have identified structural conditions that require immediate attention, the next step is a direct conversation with Kaylee-Jane. No discovery process. No lengthy proposal. A structural conversation about what your organisation needs and what addressing it requires.

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